Integrated Postal Architecture
Corvus Branch Automation

Precision Postal Software Design

The Branch/Counter Automation module of the Integrated Postal Architecture is known by the product name of *CORVUS* and is identified by the use of the *CORVUS* logo. The *CORVUS* system works in conjunction with other IPA modules by capturing transaction information at the counter and routing the information to the relevant central management systems.

The Foundation Component Set

There are many functional differences in the branch/ counter automation requirements of different Postal Enterprises. Having accepted this, it is also true to say that there are also many areas of common functionality. All Postal Enterprises need to manage the stock and cash movements between post office counters, back offices and regional and central facilities. All Postal Enterprises need to analyse their transactions and gain summary information by clerk, by post office, by client etc. All Postal Enterprises need adequate levels of security and user access control.

The Foundation Component Set (FCS) of *CORVUS* is a suite of application software components that address the common areas of functionality, required by all Postal Enterprises.

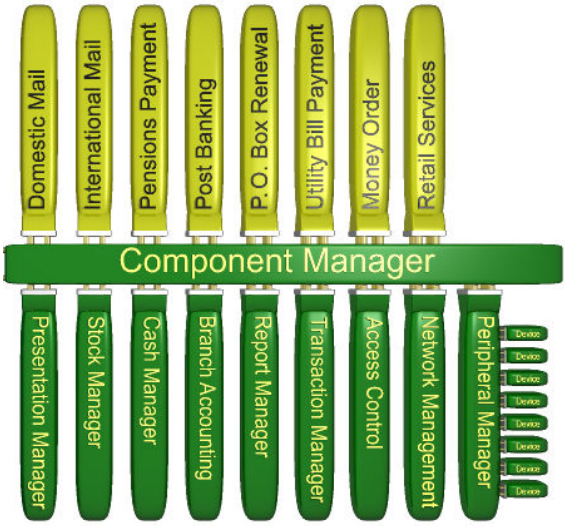
The foundation component set comprises the following functionality:

- ⇒ Transaction Manager
- ⇒ Asset Manager (Stock and Cash)
- ⇒ Branch Accounting and Client Returns
- ⇒ Report Manager
- ⇒ Access Security Control
- ⇒ Network Management
- ⇒ Presentation Manager
- ⇒ Peripheral Manager



The *CORVUS* branch automation system, provides the Postal Enterprise with the following capabilities and benefits:

- ⇒ Easily tailored to meet unique requirements
  - – Fast development and integration of the range of services
  - – Localised in all aspects i.e. language, calendar etc.
- ⇒ Fast maintenance of overall system
  - – Fast addition of new services
  - – Ease of changing profile of existing services
  - – Easy updating of changes to application and reference data
- ⇒ Graphical easy to use clerk interface
- ⇒ Automatic management of all transactions, cash and stock
- ⇒ Security of information

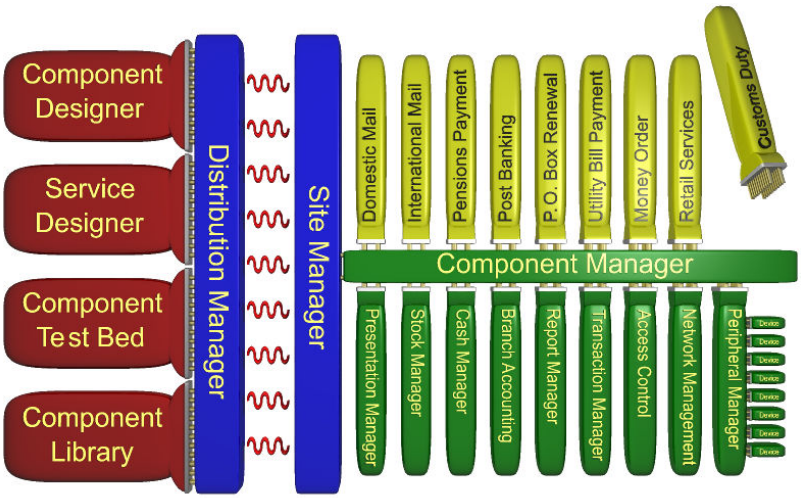


Functional Components

The functional components representing the unique services of each Post are generated to sit over the Foundation Component Set. This underlying architecture ensures the integrity of the transaction management and automatically updates the stock and cash tables and enables all necessary reporting and summarisations.

The functional components are designed independently and can run independently of the total system if required. New services can be added quickly using the power of the Component Designer Toolkit

IPA Corvus = Cost-effective, Flexible, Integrated Solutions for the Postal Industry



The *CORVUS* Component Designer Toolkit (CDT) enables:

- ⇒ Fast generation of discrete functional software components;
- ⇒ Off-line component testing;
- ⇒ Configuring multiple software components for more complex services;
- ⇒ Support for tariff tables and other reference data tables used by the system;
- ⇒ Distribution of tested software components throughout the *CORVUS* network

Component Designer Toolkit

Component Designer enables the functional software components to be generated for the *CORVUS* system. These components are generated from tables and structure diagrams that enable the system to be generated extremely quickly and easily maintained.

Upon completion of the design and generation of the functional component, the generated component can be thoroughly tested in isolation in a **Component Testbed**. This will test the integrity of the generated code and any links to external components and reference data.

Following the generation of a new transaction as a functional component, or the modification of a current component, the *CORVUS* components will be distributed throughout the postal network by the **Distribution Manager.**

The **Service Designer** is used primarily to logically incorporate multiple software components into a complete business process. Extensive use of drag-and-drop capabilities enables components to be easily linked together to achieve the complete functionality required for the process.

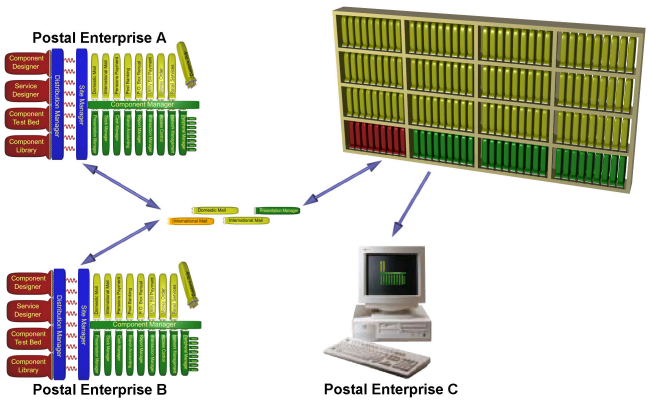
The role of **Site Manager** is to manage the hardware and software configurations of all devices on the network. Site Manager works in conjunction with *CORVUS* Distribution Manager to control and manage the distribution and management of *CORVUS* software components.

Component Library

The Component Library enables PSL to share the costs of software developments between Postal Enterprises.

With any new branch/counter automation development, there will be a degree of commonality with previously developed systems. The Component Library enables PSL to re-use software code by simply re-using components or modifying them to suit the new Post.

By using this methodology of software cost sharing PSL are able to generate new tailored counter automation systems for a fraction of the expected costs of such developments.



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